

BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus

Prayer the First Resort

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** Luke 5:15–16; Luke 11:1–4; Luke 18:1–8; John 17

 **Key Verse:** Luke 18:1 (WEB)

“He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up;”

Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16 (WEB)

¹⁵ But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶ But he withdrew himself into the desert, and prayed.”

CST Reflection

Crowds kept coming. Needs kept growing. Pressure kept rising. And Jesus did something that still challenges us: **He withdrew to pray.** He didn’t wait until everything broke. He didn’t treat prayer like a backup plan. If we’re asking *WWJD*—here’s a clear answer: **He would pray first, especially when life got louder.**

Reflection Question

When your life gets busier or more stressful, what usually gets cut first—rest, fun, prayer, or something else?

Main Course – The Mediator and the Model

Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4 (WEB)

¹ When he finished praying in a certain place, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, just as John also taught his disciples.”

² He said to them, “When you pray, say,

‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy.
May your Kingdom come.
May your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven.
³ Give us day by day our daily bread.
⁴ Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone
who is indebted to us. Bring us not into temptation,
but deliver us from the evil one.’ ”

CST Thought

The disciples didn’t ask Jesus to teach them crowds, platforms, or popularity—they asked about prayer. They watched His life and realized **prayer was the engine**. Jesus gave them a pattern: start with God’s holiness and Kingdom, trust Him for daily needs, walk in forgiveness, and ask for strength in temptation.

Reflection Question

Which part of that pattern do you rely on most—worship, daily needs, forgiveness, or spiritual strength? Which part do you skip?

Bite 2 — Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5 (WEB)

¹ He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up, ² saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn’t fear God, and didn’t respect man. ³ A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’

⁴ He wouldn’t for a while; but afterward he said to himself, ‘Though I neither fear God, nor respect man, ⁵ yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.’

CST Thought

Jesus tells a story about persistence because He knows how life works. Delay can make you tired. Silence can make you doubt. But Jesus is clear: **don’t give up**. If a person can keep showing up for justice, how much more should we keep showing up to God in faith?

Reflection Question

Is there something you used to pray about that you stopped praying for because it took too long?

Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge Luke 18:6–8 (WEB)

⁶The Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷Won’t God avenge his chosen ones, who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?”

CST Thought

God keeps His promises—always. Even in seasons of delay or confusion, His Word sustains us. Jeremiah 29 reminds us to seek God, pray for the welfare of the place we’re in, and trust His larger plan for our lives.

Author’s Testimony – A Lesson in Trust

One morning, I began my day with prayer:

“Lord, please be in charge of today. Allow me to rely on Your peace. Take control of today.”

Before 8 a.m., everything seemed to go sideways. A tenant’s water was shut off, and there were other moving pieces that could have easily sent me into stress mode. But instead of panicking, I felt an unexpected peace.

God quietly reminded me, “Just call the local store.”

I did. They gave me the name of a retired plumber. He came out, fixed the issue, and the cost was exactly the \$40 I had withdrawn the night before—without knowing why I would need it. That’s God’s foresight and favor.

Reflection Question

1. What situation did you trust Jesus to handle, and what was the result?
-
-

Dessert — Prayer that Unites, John 17:20–21 (WEB)

“Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who believe in me through their word, that they may all be one, even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me.”

CST Thought

Even before the cross, Jesus prayed for us. He sought the Father for strength, direction, and surrender. That’s the model: **prayer in the beginning, prayer in the middle, prayer at the finish.**

To-Go Box

- This life is not over until your last breath.
- Keep praying. Keep trusting. Keep resting in the One who intercedes for you.
- “Pray without ceasing.” (1 Thessalonians 5:17, WEB)

Carry this truth into every season: Jesus still meets you first in prayer.

Group Prayer – Following Jesus’ Example

Remember Jesus’ prayer in Gethsemane and His High Priestly prayer in John 17. Pray for unity, peace, and strength.

“Lord, help us to surrender our will to Yours.
Teach us to rest in Your promises,
and fill us with the same glory and unity

You shared with the Father.
Make us one in heart and purpose.
In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Notes Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study
